

but were rarely successful. The subjects indicated that 74 per cent of the time they experienced an urge to buy, the urge resulted in a purchase’.

Now, some people might believe people simply over-shop because they’re bored or unmotivated.

Financially addictive behaviour is different.

It’s compulsive and it’s secretive. While you experience an initial high over it, the truth is you’re deeply ashamed of your behaviour. If you suspect this is you, please know I see you and I’m urging you to get help. Don’t write this off as simply being your Money Type or your unchangeable Money Story because it’s not.

If you have compulsive and addictive financial behaviour (I’ve only mentioned compulsive shopping but it may otherwise be gambling or other addictive financial behaviours) please seek help. If you’re in debt as a result, speak to a debt counsellor as well as a counsellor or therapist. Until you deal with the underlying cause of your shopping, gambling or other financially compulsive habits, all the books and courses in the world won’t help.

In their book *Addicted?*, Matt Noffs and Keiran Palmer talk about the myth that you may have an addictive personality and they say:

There is very little to support this assertion ... When we begin to uncover the reasons behind why we become addicted to specific things—drugs, sex, video games, apps, smart-phones, the internet—it’s easy to notice recurring patterns. But despite everything we’ve assumed about it, addiction, it turns out, is not a single syndrome. It is not a disease. It is not an absence of morals. It is neither evil nor good. Addiction is multifaceted. Addiction is natural. And it will happen to most of us at some stage of our life in varying ways.

Life is handing so many of us who have compulsive tendencies (myself included) the tools to financially screw ourselves over. From mobile shopping devices (our phones) to easy access to credit and ‘buy now pay later’ platforms, it’s easier than ever before to develop compulsive financial behaviour and not understand how to stop.

And companies are encouraged by their shareholders and their need to grow their profits to motivate this addictive behaviour.